

Personal Music Players

Personal music players are available in a multitude of formats, sizes and feature sets. So you are bound to get confused in selecting the right one. Here are the guidelines for a smart buy



iPod touch

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Personal music players are of two types: analogue and digital. Analogue players are long-play gramophone record/cassette type, while digital players can be uncompressed (capable of CD playback) or compressed (capable of MP3/WMA/AAC playback).

The quality of analogue music is excellent to start with but deteriorates over the usage period of time. Also, mechanical devices are used for playback, which are bulky and prone to wear and tear. Portability is lesser.

There is loss of quality with each subsequent copy. Storage becomes headache when collection grows bigger.

On the other hand, the quality of digital music varies from average to excellent depending upon the conversion format and compression technique used, quality and the technological advancement of replay device. Consistency of music quality is very high. Playback devices are compact to ultra-compact. And storage is no issue for compressed music.

What's available in digital?

When going for a personal music player, you have a choice between

dedicated CD players, MP3-enabled mobiles and portable MP3 players. Of these, MP3 players are ubiquitous today.

Portable MP3 players. These are continually evolving from simple audio players to complex multimedia devices. Most can show digital photos transferred from your computer, sometimes with accompanying music. Many can also play movies and music videos downloaded from the Web.

Among the flurry of models available, Apple's iPods account for majority of MP3 players sold. Apple's success rests in part on its creation of a self-contained digital entertainment